

vision**2**learn

Business and Administration

Hints and Tips

Unit 3



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Hints and Tips Unit 3

The information in this guide will be helpful to you when you are ready to complete your assessment for the following unit:

Unit three: Principles of managing information and producing documents

Section 1 – I.T. at work

Q1. In relation to your current business environment (or one that you are familiar with), identify at least two different types of information technology that may be used when completing work tasks.

List two different types of IT that may be used in a business environment. We looked at five of these technologies in the course materials.

Q2. Outline the benefits of using information technology for doing work tasks.

As well as the learning materials, the website

<http://smallbusiness.chron.com/information-technology-business-success-4019.html>

contains some useful information regarding the benefits IT can bring to a business.

Section 2 – Managing information

Q1. Explain the purpose of agreeing objectives and deadlines when researching information.

Why is it important that you know what you are required to research and the date it needs to be completed by? If you didn't have the topic or date, what could the possible outcome be?

Q2. Identify different ways of researching, organising and reporting information.

This question is in three parts and each needs to be answered fully in the table. How would you conduct your research? How would you organise the information you collected? How would you present your findings?

Q3a. For your own organisation (or one you know well), describe the procedures that need to be followed when archiving, retrieving and deleting information.

Your answer may cover procedures for both electronic and/or paper-based information.

This question also needs to be answered in three parts. How is information archived? How would you retrieve the information you have archived? If the information is no longer required how is it disposed of?

Q3b. When following the procedures outlined in Question 3a above, think about any legal requirements that you would need to consider. Describe them below.

Are there any legal requirements that relate to the storing of information? Is there any specific legislation relating to an industry you are familiar with? If naming legislation ensure that it is written correctly and includes the date.

Q4. Explain why confidentiality is critical when managing information.

Give reasons why confidentiality is critical when managing information.
What would be the consequences if confidentiality was ignored?

Section 3 – Getting your documents right

Q1. Identify two reasons for producing documents that are fit for purpose.

Why is it important that documents are fit for purpose? Think about the structure, the content of the document and the impression it will make on the person reading it.

Q2. Use the box to describe some of the different types and styles of documents that are produced in a business environment, and when they may be used. Please give three examples.

Complete all sections of the table for 3 different types of document. Consider whether a business letter should be used? When are formal reports used? When would sending an email be appropriate?

Section 4 – Key procedures for producing documents

Q1. In most organisations, time is taken to agree the purpose, content, layout, quality standards and deadlines for the production of documents. Identify the reasons for doing this level of planning.

It is worth considering the '5 Ps' for this question – 'proper planning prevents poor performance'. Without proper planning how would the document appear?

Q2. Businesses will spend time checking finished documents for accuracy and correctness. In the table describe:

a) How is this done?

Are you the only person who checks that a document is correct? Are there tools you can use on a computer to check the spelling and grammar of documents?

b) What is the purpose of doing so?

Why do you do this? What does it achieve and what does it prevent?

Q3. Explain the purpose of following confidentiality and data protection procedures when preparing documents.

Why is it important that personal information does not fall into the hands of the wrong people? What could happen to the company if this occurs?

Q4. In business environments, there is often a requirement to use notes as the basis for text and documents.

a) Compare the different types of documents that can be produced from notes and the format of each document. Please provide two examples.

You need to include two different types of documents that can be produced from notes and describe how these documents would look. What information would you expect to find on a letter for example?

b) Explain the procedures to be followed when preparing text from notes.

When taking notes to produce a document, what things need to be considered? Why are you taking notes? What type of document will be produced from the notes, e.g. business letter or formal report? Is it important that the notes are clear and contain sufficient detail?